

AI data centers will drink our water in the next 50 years - my look at the potential problem

Posted by u/pappa_happa74 • 0 points • 77 comments

I made a video essay on the water shortage problem due to the AI boom that answers these main questions:

1. Why we can't just desalinate the water
2. Why the renewable sources of energy aren't enough
3. How to avoid the catastrophe

<https://youtu.be/EaMj8M4jnHo?si=mZYtjoLKylCtFoQo>

I'll appreciate your feedback on my analysis.

Comments

u/L_knight316 • 1 points • 2025-12-28 13:39 UTC

The water isnt going anywhere. Its the energy consumption and mass buy up of processing chips and and other commercial computer parts thats the problem

u/notatrashperson • 1 points • 2025-12-28 13:26 UTC

Feeding livestock, producing ethanol, other industrial purposes I don't know enough about. The first one is the big one though which is why people (correctly) always point to meat consumption as a much bigger environmental issue than data centers

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2025-12-28 13:24 UTC

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u/Futurology-ModTeam • 1 points • 2025-12-28 13:21 UTC

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u/dcc5594 • 2 points • 2025-12-28 13:17 UTC

50 years ago people were worried about global cooling and over population. Today the concern is global warming and declining birth rates. What's happening today says a lot about the next decade but I'm not sure it tells us much about what will be happening 50 years from now.